

Bocconi

MANAGEMENT 30060 AN INTRODUCTION



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AGENDA

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- 2. WHAT IS THIS COURSE ABOUT**
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Who we are

GUIA PIROTTI

Instructor



FRANCESCA COLLEVECCHIO

Instructor



BIAGIO MICALI

Teaching Assistant



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What is this course about



Learning objectives

- Understanding the basic concepts and theories of management
- Make students aware of the complementary roles that different actors (individuals, organizations,..) play in modern economic systems
- Develop a critical attitude regarding the objectives and the behavior of people engaged in business activities
- Provide students with the fundamental concepts required for the economic analysis of firms' processes, as well as the ability to use them in basic situations
- Provide basic tools to make decisions based on a scientific approach
- Provide a first picture of the wide range of decisions faced by managers



Theory of the firm

- Why firms exists?
- What is a corporation?
- Shareholders vs Stakeholders
- Economic activities and organization



Corporate governance

- Opportunism, fairness, cooperation ...
- Agency theory and corporate governance
- Failure of corporate governance



Measuring performance

- Why and what we need to measure
- Financial statement
- Balance sheet and Profit and loss
- Cash flows
- Assessment of performance



Organization management

- Organizational structure
- People: organizational mechanisms and culture
- Scientific approach to decision-making
- Competitive strategies
- Size advantage: Economies of scale and learning
- Diversification and vertical integration
- Cost structure and break-even point analysis
- Corporate strategies



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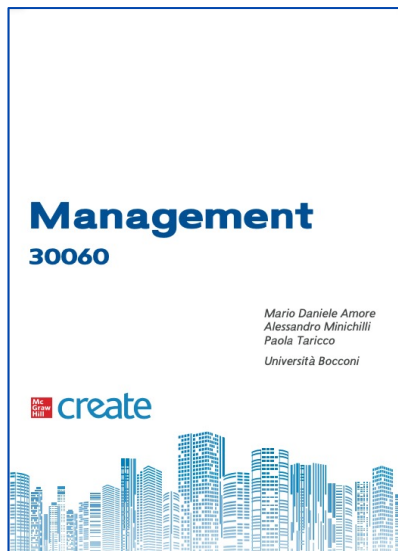
Teaching methods

- The course is designed in the purpose to combine concepts and theory with the richness of firms' real life. For this reason, students are strongly encouraged to take an active part in the learning process.
- Case Study (i.e. Patagonia, Enron, Theranos, Apple,..)
- Exercises (e.g. balance sheet, profit and loss, break-even point, ratios, economies of scale)
- Polling, breakout-groups
- Incidents, short stories, videos, business games ...



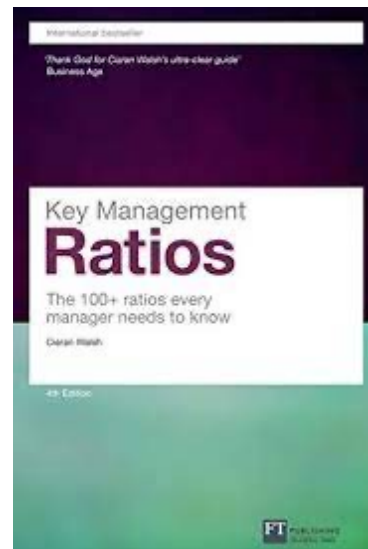
Readings

Management (2024),
Minichilli, Amore and Taricco



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Key Management Ratios (2006),
Walsh



Grading system

ATTENDING STUDENTS

Attending students will be evaluated based on the following two parts:

- A written exam (either one general exam or two mid-term exams): 80% of the final grade;
- A field project: 20% of the final grade.

WARNING

- The field project is an essential condition to be qualified as attending student, and hence to take part to mid-term exams.
- However, students are free to not realize the field assignment, and give the general exam in December or later.
- The field project grade has a validity of one academic year (up to the August 2025 exam).



Grading system

ATTENDING STUDENTS

WRITTEN EXAM

In order to take the written portion of the exam, students have two possibilities:

- The first possibility is to take the mid-term exam at the end of October and the second part of the exam in December (for attending students only). If students pass the mid-term, they are admitted to the second part. Please note that the two mid-terms will be equally weighted (50% each) to compute the grade of the written part.
- The second possibility is to take one single exam (general exam) either in December or in January/February (this option is compulsory for non-attending students); students that fail to pass the exam in the two regular sessions can give again the general exam in any other of the scheduled dates later in the academic year (March or August).
- Students that have passed the mid-term exam in October may withdraw from the second part in December, by simply not registering for it – or not showing up on that day – and can directly take the general exam. Apart from this case, under no conditions a passed exam (or part of it) can be taken again in order to improve the grade.



Grading system

ATTENDING STUDENTS

FIELD PROJECT

- Field projects represent a fundamental part of the learning process in a Management course. Hence, we strongly encourage to participate in a team project and qualify as attending student.
- Here are the basic rules:
 - Teams of six people will be formed by the instructors for the students who declare to be attending students (deadline to communicate your decision to be non attending students: September, Friday 27).
 - While attending the course is not compulsory, once a student gives his/her will to participate in a team, he/she should be able to complete the work to avoid creating problems to colleagues. For this reason, students that commit initially, but later defect from the group, will receive -1 on the overall final grade.
 - More instructions will follow in the next sessions.

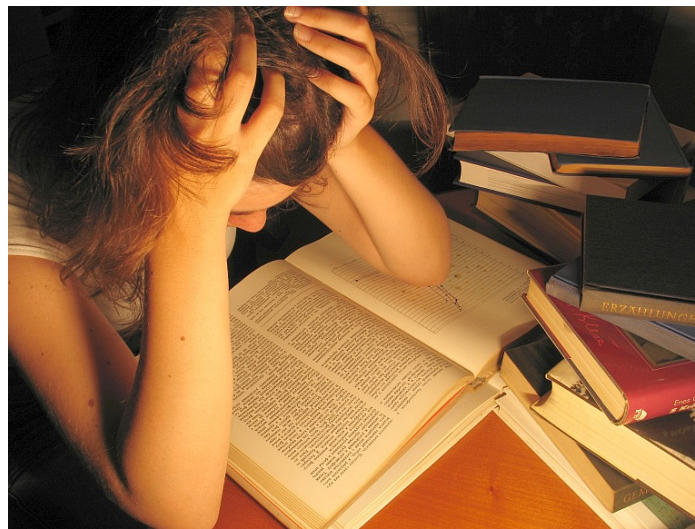


Grading system

NON ATTENDING STUDENTS

WRITTEN EXAM

- Non-Attending students will be evaluated based on a general written exam only (100% of the grade), which can be taken either in December or in January/February, or in any of the future exam sessions.



Note: Realistic representation of a non-attending student



Blackboard platform

The screenshot displays the Blackboard platform interface for a course. At the top, a navigation bar includes links for Content, Calendar, Discussions, Gradebook, Messages, and Analytics. The main content area is divided into three sections:

- Course Faculty:** Lists two instructors: CEDRIC GUTIERREZ MORENO and PAOLA TARICCO, both with 'INSTRUCTOR' roles. A 'Show more' link is available below the list.
- Details & Actions:** Contains several course management options:
 - Roster:** Includes a link to 'View everyone on your course'.
 - Course Groups:** Includes a link to 'View sets & groups'.
 - Progress Tracking:** Currently set to 'Off'.
 - Blackboard Collaborate:** Shows 'No session scheduled'.
 - Announcements:** Includes a link to 'Create announcement'.
 - Books & Tools:** Includes a link to 'View course & institution tools'.
 - Question Banks:** Includes a link to 'Manage banks'.
- Course Content:** Lists available course materials:
 - Bocconi Syllabus:** Visible to students. Includes a link to 'Click here to view the course syllabus.'
 - Class Attendance:** Visible to students. Includes a link to 'Click here to record the attendance.'
 - Egea - Help:** Hidden from students. Includes a link to 'Find out everything you need to know about the new Egea tool.'
 - Egea - Course Gallery:** Visible to students. Includes a link to 'Your courses' publications gallery.'



Some basic rules

- Be punctual
- Remember to read the syllabus: almost all the answers to your doubts can be found there



THANK YOU



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